

## **Module 9: Implementation of a Management System**

### **Executing the Project Work**

#### Key Work Assignments:

##### 1. Data Gathering and Analysis

- a. Gather and analyze relevant data (e.g., emissions, compliance, production planning).
- b. Example: In an environmental management system, review compliance with legislation and shortlist the most appropriate solutions.

##### 2. Recommending Solutions & Roadmaps

- a. Recommend solutions with an implementation roadmap.
- b. Example: In a health and safety system, suggest a plan to increase workplace risk awareness, expecting fewer accidents.

##### 3. Presenting and Securing Decisions

- a. Present recommendations and obtain decisions and acceptance from top management.
- b. Example: In an information security system, identify vulnerabilities, propose fixes, and ensure management approves execution and monitoring progress.

##### 4. Execution & Follow-Up

- a. Ensure the execution of the project plan and measure outcomes.
- b. Example: Track the impact of safety training to verify if workplace accidents have decreased.

#### Project Manager's Role:

- a. Oversee the execution of team assignments.
- b. Ensure adherence to the plan and track progress.

### **Work Assignment in Project Management**

##### 1. Definition

- a. A work assignment is a task within the project plan that drives project progress.
- b. Can be done by an individual or a team.

##### 2. Agenda Preparation

- a. Send an agenda before each work assignment.
- b. Include start time, topics, and end time.
- c. Ensure material from previous assignments is submitted on time for review.

##### 3. Execution During Assignment

- a. Follow the agenda and discuss planned items.
- b. Conclude with a to-do list:

- c. Define tasks, assign responsibilities, and set deadlines.
- 4. Post-Assignment Actions
  - a. Complete your assigned tasks.
  - b. Be available for help if needed.
  - c. Regularly follow up on the to-do list status to keep the project on track.
- 5. Communication & Priority
  - a. Ensure all team members understand task priorities and deadlines.
  - b. Highlight the importance of timely contributions.
- 6. Common To-Do List Items
  - a. New procedures, forms, layout changes.
  - b. Implementation tasks, study records, trend analysis.
  - c. Preparing training events, and making decisions based on discussions.

### **Managing Work Assessment and Resources in Project Management**

- 1. Resource Planning
  - a. Ensure agreed resources are available for the project.
  - b. Anticipate resource needs and align availability with organizational plans.
- 2. Time Commitment
  - a. Confirm team members have the necessary time to work on the project.
  - b. Ensure managers can attend required meetings and contribute as needed.
- 3. Follow-Through on Decisions
  - a. Verify that management executes decisions related to investments in quality, safety, environmental, or digital security.
  - b. Ensure managers lead by example in implementing and following new practices.
- 4. Issue Management
  - a. Identify and address obstacles that affect project execution.
  - b. Work with managers to resolve issues, escalating to the project sponsor if necessary.
- 5. Handling Multiple Work Assignments
  - a. Be mindful of your capacity to manage multiple simultaneous work assignments.
  - b. Avoid becoming the bottleneck for project progress by considering your workload.

## **Enabling Smooth Project Execution**

1. Training Team Members
  - a. Provide an initial overview of the management system standards.
  - b. Offer tailored, subject-specific training before starting new tasks (e.g., ISO 9001 requirements for procurement).
2. Co-Creating Documents
  - a. Assist in writing documents, procedures, and forms.
  - b. Use templates as a starting point, but co-create with team members and their managers.
  - c. Involve people to reduce resistance to change and increase ownership and commitment.
3. Documenting Appropriately
  - a. Only create mandatory documents required by the standard.
  - b. Non-mandatory documents should fit the organization's needs.
  - c. Larger organizations with complex products or higher staff turnover often need more detailed documentation.
  - d. Smaller organizations with simpler processes may need fewer and shorter documents.

## **Gathering Information and Recommending Changes**

1. Information Gathering
  - a. Observe operations and ask questions to understand current practices.
  - b. Be cautious of responses like "we've always done it this way" and explore alternatives.
  - c. Analyze existing tracked information to identify areas for improvement.
2. Identifying Outdated Practices
  - a. Use your experience to spot outdated or inefficient practices during visits.
  - b. Engage with department staff to understand issues related to these practices.
3. Recommending Improvements
  - a. Provide recommendations that can improve performance or reduce problems and costs.

Examples:

- b. Inaccurate inventory due to unrestricted access in warehouses.
- c. High waste disposal costs due to improper waste separation.

## **Introducing Documentation and Changes in Day-to-Day Use**

1. Document Production and Review
  - a. Produce procedures, instructions, forms, and rules.
  - b. Review documents with users and managers for initial and final approval to ensure they are useful, suitable, and simple.
2. Approval Process
  - a. Approval authority should be outlined in the project plan or a document specifying approvals by department or topic.
  - b. Once approved, documents can be formally introduced into the management system (digitally or on paper).
3. Implementation of New Practices
  - a. Approved documents do not guarantee smooth implementation—effort is needed to help people see the benefits and adopt new practices.
4. Monitoring Implementation
  - b. Check if new practices are being followed and if results meet expectations.
  - c. Use feedback, performance metrics, or conformance verifications (e.g., daily waste segregation checks) to monitor progress.

## **Overcoming the Resistance to Change**

1. Identify Opposition and Response
  - a. Identify potential opposition and reasons (e.g., extra effort for waste segregation).
  - b. Prepare team responses (e.g., wrong segregation as a possible outcome).
2. List Obstacles and Aids
  - a. Obstacles: Few containers, far locations, lack of information, doubt about top management support.
  - b. Aids: Posters with clear instructions, top management encouragement.
3. Prioritize Obstacles and Aids
  - a. Rank obstacles by importance (e.g., lack of management support, distance to containers).
  - b. Rank aids by strength (e.g., management support is the strongest aid).
4. Explain the Benefits of Change
  - a. Show how new practices save costs and meet current business needs (e.g., cost of contaminated vs. segregated waste disposal).
5. Develop Countermeasures
  - b. Counter obstacles (e.g., add more containers, have management talk directly to staff).
6. Plan the Change

- c. Include communication, training, document distribution, and a monitoring schedule in your change plan.
7. Implement and Adapt
- d. Follow the plan and be ready to address unplanned problems swiftly to emphasize the importance of the change.